1 Day 1 — Introduce

"The Mixed-Up Chameleon" · Week of July 21

Total time: ~2 hours
7 activity blocks

📖 Read-Aloud

15 min

1. Read "Only a Toad" aloud together. Use different voices for the characters — make the toad grumpy and the other animals proud.
2. After reading, ask: "What was the toad's problem? How did he solve it?"
3. Talk about a time she wanted to be something different. "Have you ever wished you could be like someone else?"

🚀 If she breezes through

Ask her to retell the story in her own words. Then connect: "How is the toad like a chameleon? We'll find out this week!"

🌱 If she needs more support

Focus on the pictures first. Ask "what's happening here?" for each page before reading the words together.

Materials: "Only a Toad" story (or read online)

🔤 Phonics

15 min

1. Write these word pairs on a whiteboard: **hid / hide**, **rid / ride**, **slid / slide**. Read them together.
2. Ask: "What do you notice about these words? What's the same? What's different?" Guide her to see the silent e pattern.
3. Sort word cards into two columns: **-id** words and **-ide** words. She places each card and reads it aloud.

🚀 If she breezes through

Add blends: *grid, pride, bride*. Can she hear the pattern in longer words? Try making up silly -ide words.

🌱 If she needs more support

Start with just 3 words total. Sound out each one together slowly. Use fingers to tap each sound.

Materials: Whiteboard + markers, word cards (print or write on index cards)

✏️ Spelling Pretest

10 min

1. Say each word clearly. Use it in a sentence. Say the word again. She writes it.
2. Words: **hid, rid, kid, lid, slid, hide, ride, side, wide, slide**
3. Check together. Circle any she missed — those are her focus words this week.

💡 *This is diagnostic, not graded. Celebrate what she already knows! The words she misses become her personal focus list for the week.*

Materials: Lined paper, pencil

📚 Reading

20 min

1. Read the decodable books together: "Sid the Salamander" and "Ben and Sid." These are practice books with lots of -id words.
2. Let her read as much as she can. Help with tricky words by pointing to the sounds — don't just say the word for her.
3. After each book, ask one question: "What happened in this story?" Listen for her to retell the beginning, middle, and end.

🚀 If she breezes through

Have her read one book independently, then tell you about it. Ask: "Which character did you like? Why?"

🌱 If she needs more support

Echo-read: you read a sentence, she reads the same sentence right after you. Build confidence before independent reading.

Materials: Decodable readers (or similar books with short -id / -ide words)

✍️ Writing

15 min

1. Ask: "What's your favorite topic to read about? Dinosaurs? Space? Animals? Princesses?"
2. Help her write 2–3 sentences about her favorite topic. She can draw a picture alongside her writing.
3. Read her sentences back to her. Point out what she did well: "You started with a capital letter!" Celebrate the writing.

🚀 If she breezes through

Ask her to add one detail: "What's the coolest thing about [topic]?" Push for a third or fourth sentence.

🌱 If she needs more support

She dictates, you write. Then she copies one sentence below yours. The goal is ideas first, handwriting second.

Materials: Lined paper, pencils, crayons

📝 Grammar

10 min

1. Write on the whiteboard: **"The chameleon"** — ask: "Is this a sentence? Why not?"
2. Now write: **"The chameleon changed colors."** — ask: "Is THIS a sentence? What makes it different?"
3. Together, discover the rule: a sentence needs a **naming part** (who or what) and a **telling part** (what happened).

🚀 If she breezes through

Give her 3 word groups and ask her to sort: sentence or not a sentence? Let her explain WHY for each.

🌱 If she needs more support

Act it out! "I am the naming part" (stand up). "Now YOU be the telling part" (do an action). Make it physical.

Materials: Whiteboard + markers

🔬 Science Center — Chameleon Habitat

30 min

1. Talk about where chameleons live. Look at pictures online or in a book together. What do they see? Trees, leaves, warm weather.
2. Build a mini habitat in a shoe box: use real leaves, twigs, and sand for the ground. Add flowers from construction paper.
3. Cut out a chameleon from green construction paper. Place it in the habitat. Can she make it blend in?
4. Discuss: "Why do chameleons change color? How does blending in help them stay safe?"

Materials: Shoe box, real leaves + twigs, sand, construction paper, scissors, glue, crayons

🛒 Everything You Need for Day 1

- ✦ "Only a Toad" story
- ✦ Decodable readers (-id/-ide words)
- ✦ Pencils + crayons
- ✦ Shoe box
- ✦ Construction paper
- ✦ Whiteboard + dry erase markers
- ✦ Lined paper
- ✦ Index cards (word sort)
- ✦ Real leaves, twigs, sand
- ✦ Scissors + glue